

51 Modifying the balance and the consolidated uses and meanings attached to heritage may generate frictions and even spark conflicts among different groups benefiting or losing ground with reference to certain heritage pieces, historic places or the cultural practices and intangible values attached to it. This conflict can be anticipated and dealt through cultural activities, events and the arts, that can creatively generate new platforms for dialogue. Hull is an important example for this practice. Intercultural initiatives were envisioned since the start, given the relevant presence of migrant workers and their weak recognition within official cultural policy making. In addition, the use of arts and playful events for mobilizing heritage building and activating historic places for building a new and more attractive narrative of the city and community proved to be successful. In Wrocław, the collective processing of a difficult cultural identity and social history was stimulated through recognizing specific heritage buildings and places pertaining to multiple communities of the past and of the present. This was a way not only done to valorise heritage for tourists, but also to input social learning and cultural innovation. All the cases showed that promoting social dialogue about and through heritage is much cheaper and less time consuming than managing conflicts that may derive from a different or more intense use of heritage and historic places. While a majority of events occurred in the UNESCO recognized city centre of Matera in 2019, the ECoC also served as an opportunity to recognize and promote other aspects of the city's less recognized heritage. Several pathways were developed to highlight the modernist neighbourhoods of the city and the unused quarry, Cava del Sole, was converted into an event space with performances taking place throughout the year and utilizing past industrial and landscape heritage spaces in new ways. Communication regarding mega-events typically requires one single strong narrative or image for the city and program. This may clash with the multiple interests and perspectives of actors and stakeholders on the transformation of the city in general and it may limit the rich interpretations of heritage and places in particular. In the case of Hull, despite the difficulties and painful memories attached to it, rediscovering the maritime heritage of the city became a great opportunity for planning long-term interventions, as well as for mobilizing different strata and groups of the local and regional population. In this sense, expanding the cultural ownership and the possible narratives for the mega-events and the involved heritage can become strategic also for inclusivity. Clearly, the case of Pafos had to face the heritage of the Turkish Cypriot population, to make sense of the places that historically hosted that community and that became deserted after the 1974 conflict which divided the island's territory. This was part of the core narrative (despite the overarching motto of the event: "Linking Continents-Bridging Cultures") but resurfaced in multiple concrete projects as the revitalization of the Mouttallos Turkish-Cypriots neighbourhood that was partially abandoned. 4. From the specificities of case studies to heritage-conscious mega-event policies The propositions presented in this article are based on the in-depth study of the five cases and real-time observation of the Matera-Basilicata 2019 ECoC. Given the